



Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's
SARDAR PATEL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
(Autonomous)

Munshi Nagar, Andheri(W), Mumbai – 400 058.

Minutes of the 10th Meeting of the Governing Body

The 10th Meeting of the Board of Governors was held on 03rd September 2021 at 4:00 p.m, in online mode. Following members of the Board attended the meeting:

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|----|-----------------------|---|----------------------------|
| 1. | Prof. Sesha Iyer | - | Chairman |
| 2. | Prof. Prachi Gharpure | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 3. | Shri. Asif Mulla | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 4. | Shri. Suresh Mhatre | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 5. | Prof. V. M. Gadre | - | Member, from academia |
| 6. | Prof. S. G. Bhirud | - | Member, University Nominee |
| 7. | Prof. Y.S. Rao | - | Teaching Member |
| 8. | Prof. Surendra Rathod | - | Teaching Member |
| 9. | Prof. B.N. Chaudhari | - | Member Secretary |

Following members were granted the leave of absence:

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|----|-----------------------|---|-----------------------------|
| 1. | Prof. Ranjan Banerjee | - | Management Nominee |
| 2. | Prof. Pramod Naik | - | Nominee of State Government |
| 3. | Prof. Manju Singh | - | UGC Nominee |
| 4. | Shri Rahul Chari | - | Member, from industry |

1. Confirmation of the 8th and 9th Meetings of the Governing Body held on 27th March and 22nd May 2021 respectively in online mode.

The minutes of the 8th and 9th meeting of the Governing Body were annexed as annexures A and B in the agenda of the 10th meeting, and agenda was circulated to all members prior to the meeting. The Principal read out the minutes and the members reviewed the minutes and since no suggestions were received, the minutes of 8th and 9th meetings are confirmed.

Resolution 01/10: The minutes of the 8th and 9th meetings of the GB as enclosed in annexures A and B are confirmed.

2. Action Taken Report for the 8th and 9th Meeting of the Governing Body

The Principal narrated the Actions taken on the resolutions of the 8th and 9th Meeting of the Governing Body enclosed as annexure C in the agenda of the 10th meeting. Members have noted the actions taken and expressed their satisfaction. Mhatre Sir stressed upon making a quarterly budget considering the extra ordinary time institute is passing through till it resumes the normal life. Further he suggested to submit the budget to the finance committee first and then to the Governing Body. Principal thanked the Governing Body for extending its full support for merging of the present



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courses and starting two new undergraduate courses. Principal thanked Chairman sir for his special efforts in getting the speedy approval from the head office. Chairman inquired about when the proposed merger and starting of the new courses will be effective. The Principal informed that both will be effective from academic year 21-22. Chairman further inquired about the fees approval from the FRA. The Principal informed that the institute has received fees approval from the FRA. Further, the Principal thanked all the members for detailed deliberations, vital inputs given towards 7th pay implementation. He informed the GB about the disbursement of the arrears for the financial year 20-21. Chairman also expressed the concern about the NBA accreditation, which may arise due to this merger, and whether the new courses will come under autonomy or not. Principal answered that all new courses will automatically come under the autonomy and there will not be any issue over the NBA accreditation of the programs, as the courses which are merged will continue to exist till next 3 years and will be gradually merged. He further informed that NBA cycle is over and we need to apply afresh for the NBA. On this, members expressed that few batches will roll out without NBA. The Principal informed that the extension of the accreditation is under pipeline and will be effective for the batches already studying in higher classes (second year onwards) and hence there will not be issue of some batch graduating without NBA accreditation status.

Resolution 02/10 : The Governing Body has noted the actions taken over the minutes of 8th and 9th meetings.

3. Approval to start autonomous Ph.D. program at the institute.

Principal has briefed the GB regarding the problems institute is facing towards running Ph.D. program of Mumbai University. The processes of admission, guide approval etc were narrated. Further, he informed about the recent empowerment of the autonomous institutes as spelled out by the UGC guidelines for autonomous colleges. He also pointed out the statutes for the autonomous colleges under Maharashtra University Act and explained rationale behind proposing this start of autonomous Ph.D. program at the institute. He also informed the GB that already few autonomous colleges in the State are empowered by their parent universities. VJTI also runs its own Ph.D. program under Mumbai University. Chairman suggested to confirm with the University whether the degree will be awarded by the University or not. Dr. Prachi Gharpure informed that, in past few Principals met Vice Chancellor in this regard, who flatly refused this. Principal requested the GB to approve this in principle so as to take appropriate follow up with the University. Mhatre sir suggested to approve this proposal in principle subject to the guidelines framed and approved by the academic council. Prof. Vikram Gadre suggested to record that the board discussed this matter at length and was keen to accept, however the board was clear that all processes to be followed, no missing links should remain. Suggested to resolve as "The board resolved that this is desirable in the long run and all steps should be taken to implement this while keeping in mind following things:

- No compromise in the quality of the Ph.D. program

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- Making sure that the Ph.D. program enhances the administration and academic structure of the academic program
- All stake holders to be consulted and inputs taken before finalizing the structure.”

Principal assured the GB to revisit this proposal carefully drafting the rules ensuring that Mumbai University rules for Ph.D. become subset of the rules of the Ph.D. program at the institute, with wide deliberations with all stake holders and seeking approval from the academic council.

Resolution 03/10 : The GB resolves that starting the autonomous Ph.D. program is desirable in the long run and it is to be ensured that no compromise is made in the quality of Ph.D. program, and all stakeholders are duly consulted in finalizing the structure of the Ph.D. program. The Governing Body approves this in principle.

4. Fees revision for the Ph.D. program.

The Principal briefed the GB about the rationale behind proposing the fees revision for Ph.D. program. He expressed his concern over the present fees and shrinking admissions for the Ph.D. program. He expressed the need to attract bright young students for the Ph.D. program and even offer them fellowship from institute funds or from industry support. He advocated for the reduction in the fees for Ph.D. program. Chairman requested Prof Gadre to explain the IITB practice towards this. Prof. Gadre informed that in IITs too, some concession is given to full time scholars. He suggested that some relaxation can be given to the Research Scholars contributing to academic activity. He suggested to minute that “the board welcomes the prospect of finding ways – financial and otherwise to attract the best talent to the P.h.D. program and study be carried out and specific recommendations to be brought before the board”. Dr Prachi Gharpure suggested that since the institute is self-financed institution, the expenditure towards sponsoring the publication, journal subscription, laboratory usage, special facility if any, honorarium to guide etc. need to be calculated and fees be arrived ensuing that Ph.D. program is totally self-supporting program. Prof Gadre expressed that honorarium to the Guide is uncomfortable and is not the good practice. Prof. Rao explained that there are some external guides, and they need to be paid. Prof Rathod opined in unison with Prof. Rao. Principal also expressed his discomfort with existing practice of paying the honorarium to the in house guides and ensured revisiting the Ph.D. program fees in totality considering the philosophy, approach, tangential and nontangential benefits etc.

Resolution 04/10 : The Governing Body welcomes the prospect of finding ways, financial or otherwise to attract the best talent to the Ph.D. program and directs that specific recommendations after careful study be brought out before the board.





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5. Revision of Faculty Empowerment and Establishing the Professional Development Allowance for regular faculty.

Principal stressed importance of the faculty empowerment. He pointed out that the faculty is the most important stakeholder of an institute. While students spend their 4 years in the institute, by large, teacher spends 25-30 years with the institute. Empowerment of faculty in turn is an empowerment of the student. While investment on empowerment of a student is recurring, the investment on empowerment of faculty gives long term returns. Institutes need to ensure continuous value addition of each faculty. He informed that S.P.I.T understands this generously and has few empowerment schemes in place for the faculty. Faculty is already supported for the FDP, publishing paper in the conferences, membership of professional societies, filing the patent etc. To encourage this further, professional development allowance for regular faculty is proposed revisiting existing schemes / policies and articulating few new schemes under the broad umbrella of Professional Development Allowance for the faculty.

The members appreciated this initiative. Prof Gadre remarked that this spending should finally contribute to teaching. Also, students should be inculcated with these thoughts that they should contribute to the running of institute i.e. build a sense of social responsibility. But parents may be concerned about their wards progress. Can students be encouraged to think that in the larger good he too will benefit. He suggested to use their energy to build the institute. In the long run their community, nation benefits. He remarked that we should teach them that by doing this in the long run they will benefit. He further expressed that this level of depth should be thought of while framing such scheme. Appreciating the philosophical inputs from Prof. Gadre, the Chairman suggested to go by Prof. Gadre's guidance and bring more clarity to this. Dr. Prachi Gharpure also suggested to put the entire proposal in table form. The Principal assured that this and the student empowerment schemes will be presented again with due deliberations and formulation. Prof. Gadre suggested to place on record the appreciation for Prof Chaudhari for initiating such process.

Resolution 05/10 : The GB appreciated the proposals towards faculty empowerment schemes and Student empowerment schemes, however, deferred those at present and directed to put again bringing more clarity.

6. Student Empowerment Schemes

Covered in Resolution 05/10

7. Appointment of ad-hoc faculty.

The Principal briefed the Governing Body regarding the faculty strength at present. He informed that institute had discontinued 17 ad-hoc faculty in June 2020. During pandemic, institute has optimized the available manpower. From new academic year, two new undergraduate programs which are approved by AICTE will be added. This will increase the intake of the institute to 360 from the present intake of 240. He

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pointed out that all these call for induction of few faculty members of different domains, as per the need of academics, and ensuring the STR below 20. He estimated that institute needs to induct 10 ad-hoc faculty for the year and requested for permission to induct 10 ad-hoc faculty. Further, it is proposed to offer a consolidated salary of Rs. 60,000/- p.m. for (PG qualified teacher) and Rs. 75,000 (for Ph.D qualified teacher or an experienced teacher).

The Chairman and Dr. Prachi Gharpure consented on this and expressed that STR should be kept below 20, all the time. The proposal is unanimously accepted.

Resolution 07/10: The Governing Body approves the induction of required number of ad-hoc faculty so as to ensure STR below 20, with a proposed consolidated salary of Rs. 60,000/- pm for PG qualified teacher and Rs. 75,000/- for Ph.D qualified teacher.

8. New Dean Structure, Role and Responsibilities for Deans/HoD/Faculty, Code of conduct for faculty and institute expectation matrix for the faculty

Deferred for the next meeting

9. Code of Conduct for the Staff and Students

Deferred for the next meeting

10. Appointment of Prof. Dilip Patil as Professor Emeritus.

Principal briefed about Prof. Dilip Patil, a retired professor from IISc, Bangalore. His resume was circulated. He informed the GB that a senior Professor from IITB has strongly recommended Prof. Patil to get benefit of his association. Chairman inquired whether such Emeritus faculty will be considered by NBA. Shri Mhatre sir informed that such faculty members are considered upto 20 % of total faculty strength. Prof. Gadre commented that Professor Emeritus status is appropriate.

Resolution 10/10: The GB approves the induction of Prof. Dilip Patil as Professor Emeritus with monthly honorarium of Rs. 1,00,000/- .

11. Re-appointment of Shri Vinod Sikka as Training and Placement Officer

Principal briefed about Shri Vinod Sikka, who is working as the Training and Placement officer of the institute since July 2012. He further informed that Initially Shri Sikka was given an honorarium of Rs. 53,000/- p.m. and it was raised to Rs. 60,000/- in 2018. In addition, he is given an honorarium of Rs. 25000/- from TBI for contributing in TBI activities. Appreciating Shri Sikka's commitment to the work, discipline, his cordial relations with most of the faculty, and his efforts towards the placement of the students, Principal proposed to continue him for one more year (1st Nov. 21 to 31st Oct.22) with a fixed honorarium of Rs. 1,00,000/- p.m. It was proposed to stop the



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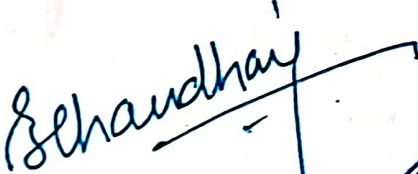
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honorarium from SPTBI. Dr. Prachi expressed that institute is fortunate to have such a passionate and energetic person. Chairman suggested to continue the payment through TBI to keep his interests alive in TBI activities and give the required raise. Further he suggested to groom a young faculty for sustainability and hierarchical continuation. Dr. Prachi commented that instead of the young faculty, a young industry experienced person may be inducted. Prof. Gadre seconded this opinion.

Resolution 11/10: The GB approves the continuation of Shri Sikka for one more year with an increased honorarium of Rs. 75000/- p.m. from S.P.I.T besides the honorarium from the SPTBI.

12. Any other point with the permission of Chair.

Chairman suggested to defer the additional points for the next meeting.


Principal
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DR. SESH IYER
CHAIRMAN
GOVERNING BODY
Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's
Sardar Patel Institute of Technology
Andheri(W), Mumbai-58.



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Annexure B

Action Taken Report on Decisions of 10th Governing Body Meeting

Agenda Item No.	Description	GB resolution	Action Taken
1	Confirmation of minutes	<i>R10/01: The minutes of the 10th meeting of the Governing Body, held on 3rd September 2021 are confirmed.</i>	The minutes are signed and documented.
2	Approval to start the PhD program	<i>Resolution 03/10 : The GB resolves that starting the autonomous Ph.D program is desirable in the long run and it is to be ensured that no compromise is made in the quality of Ph.D program, and all stakeholders are duly consulted in finalizing the structure of the Ph.D program. The Governing Body approves this in principle.</i>	Institute has framed the rules and regulations after deliberations and discussions with the faculty and present research students. The proposal was put in academic council for consideration. After deliberations in the academic council, the item is temporarily put on hold.
3	Fees revision for Ph.D program	<i>Resolution 04/10 : The Governing Body welcomes the prospect of finding ways, financial or otherwise to attract the best talent to the Ph.D program and directs that specific recommendations after careful study be brought out before the board.</i>	Institute is working on this.
4	Revision of Faculty Empowerment and Establishing the Professional Development Allowance for regular faculty.	<i>Resolution 05/10: The GB appreciated the proposals towards faculty empowerment schemes and Student empowerment schemes, however, deferred those at present and directed to put again bringing more clarity.</i>	Institute is working on this.

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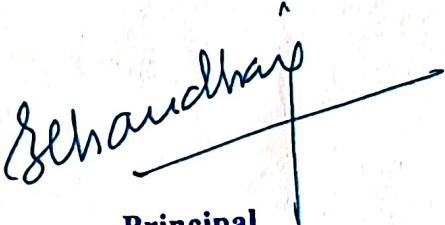




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5	Appointment of Ad-hoc faculty	<i>Resolution 07/10: The Governing Body approves the induction of required number of ad-hoc faculty so as to ensure STR below 20, with a proposed consolidated salary of Rs. 60,000/- pm for PG qualified teacher and Rs. 75,000/- for Ph.D qualified teacher.</i>	The required number of faculty are appointed on ad-hoc basis.
6	Appointment of Prof. Dilip Patil	<i>Resolution 10/10: The GB approves the induction of Prof. Dilip Patil as Professor Emeritus with monthly honorarium of Rs. 1,00,000/- .</i>	The institute has inducted Prof. Dilip Patil and he is teaching 2 undergraduate courses.
7	Continuation of Shri Sikka	<i>Resolution 11/10: The GB approves the continuation of Shri Sikka for one more year with an increased honorarium of Rs. 750000/- p.m. from S.P.I.T besides the honorarium from the SPTBI.</i>	Continuation order is issued to Shri Sikka for one more year with the approved honorarium


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